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POLICY & PROGRAMMES

European Commission releases the EU Space Act

On 25 June 2025, the European Commission launched the EU Space Act, a legislative proposal introducing a unified European framework for space activities. Aimed at ensuring safety, resilience, and environmental sustainability, the Space Act seeks to boost the competitiveness of the EU space sector by replacing the current fragmented approach of 13 national regulations with a harmonised single market. The proposal intends to reduce complexity and business costs, facilitating the growth and operations of companies, especially SMEs and start-ups. The Space Act focuses on safety, requiring debris mitigation, collision avoidance, and data sharing; resilience, with cybersecurity rules and risk assessments amid rising cyber threats; and sustainability, promoting responsible disposal and greener operations.

Beyond regulation, the Space Act has the ambition to support the growth of in-space operations and services, unlocking new commercial markets while maintaining safe and sustainable infrastructure. It also aims to reinforce the security and continuity of critical services such as satellite navigation and Earth Observation, with the latter market expected to nearly double by 2033.

ESA Council reinforces global partnerships and advances resilience programme

At its 334th meeting on 11-12 June 2025 in Paris, the ESA Council approved a resolution enabling the development of the European Resilience from Space Programme, set to be proposed as an optional programme at the upcoming ESA Ministerial Council in November. The initiative aims to enhance Europe's resilience and security using high-resolution Earth Observation, supported by navigation and telecommunications in a system of systems approach.

At the Council, **Commissioner Kubilius held a keynote address** that highlighted three key points:

- Geopolitical context: Europe must rapidly strengthen its defence readiness, with space playing a central role in ensuring autonomy and security amid rising threats.
- Space capabilities for defence & resilience: It is crucial that the EU rapidly develops and protects critical systems, such as secure communications, high-revisit Earth Observation, and resilient navigation, to support defence and civilian resilience.
- EU-ESA cooperation: A recently established joint task force is advancing major programmes like the European Remote Sensing Satellite (ERS) programme and a future Earth Observation Governmental Service.

The Council also held in-depth discussions on the potential impact of proposed budget cuts to NASA in the U.S. President's FY2026 request. While analysis remains ongoing, ESA Member States have reaffirmed their commitment to strengthening European space autonomy and resilience. ESA Director General Josef Aschbacher underscored **the importance of international collaboration, highlighting recent agreements** with ISRO and Canada, among others. Several new cooperation agreements were approved, including:

- An extended MoU with UN-Habitat to support sustainable urban development using EO.
- A renewed five-year agreement with the European Maritime Safety Agency for maritime safety, surveillance, and pollution monitoring.
- A new initiative with Ukraine's State Space Agency for technical collaboration in EO, space exploration, and space weather.

ESA's Living Planet Symposium 2025 takes place in Vienna

From 23-27 June 2025, ESA hosted the **Living Planet Symposium (LPS) in Vienna, a premier tri-annual Earth Observation (EO) conference, bringing together almost 7,000 participants from 119 countries under the theme "From Observation to Climate Action and Sustainability for Earth"**. The event featured an extensive programme of scientific presentations, capacity-building sessions, and agoras, highlighting the growing relevance of EO across science, policy, and operational domains.



Credit: ESA

A major milestone of the week was the **signing of a landmark Memorandum of Intent between ESA and the Ramsar Convention on Wetlands,** formalising their long-standing collaboration on environmental protection. The agreement outlines new avenues to harness EO data for wetland conservation and sustainable development.

The Kenya Space Agency officially joined the Space Climate Observatory (SCO) by signing its charter on 28 June 2025, aiming to strengthen Kenya's capacity for climate monitoring and early warning systems, and promote regional collaboration. Led by CNES, the SCO uses satellite-based EO to support global climate resilience initiatives.

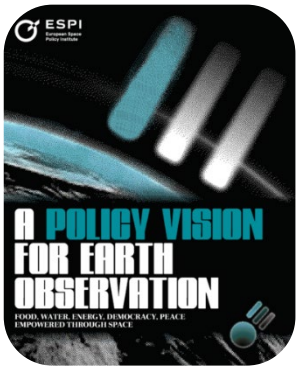
ESA also announced new steps to integrate satellite data into global environmental reporting frameworks through its Fundamental Data Records initiative. This included a **contract with the Finnish government and the Finnish Meteorological Institute to establish a calibration and validation "supersite."** ESA is also collaborating with the Taskforce on Nature-related Financial Disclosures to align satellite data with sustainability reporting standards.



Credit: ESA

In the commercial EO sector, **six New Space companies officially joined the Copernicus Contributing Missions framework,** further expanding Europe's operational capabilities. The new entrants include Germany's Marble Imaging, Portugal's GEOSAT, UK-based SatVu, France's ORUS and Unseenlabs, and Belgium's Aerospacelab. ESA also signed a Framework Agreement with JAXA on climate collaboration and **awarded a contract to ISISPACE to develop the "Tango" mission under the New Space Scout Missions programme**.

Throughout the week, **ESPI was active across multiple sessions and engagements**, with a key moment being the official publication of ESPI's **"Policy Vision for Earth Observation"** (download here). The Vision aims to initiate a structured dialogue on maximising the policy impact of EO by aligning space programmes with the needs of decision-makers across key domains, such as climate, security, food and water, energy, diplomacy, and digital transition. ESPI also co-hosted, together with ISPRS, a **high-level Evening Debate focused on boosting the policy impact of commercial EO** (key takeaways here) and a **session on unlocking climate action through EO** (key takeaways here).



ESA publishes Technology2040: A Vision for the European Space Agency



Credit: ESA

ESA has released its Technology 2040 vision, outlining a roadmap for Europe's role in shaping a sustainable and innovative future in space. Emphasises European technological leadership, and environmental resilience, the document envisions a thriving circular and sustainable space economy by 2040, with zero-debris operations, advanced-in-orbit self-assembly of large space structures, and high-speed precision vehicles operating in Very Low Earth Orbit (VLEO). It anticipates a fully interconnected Solar System through a robust space internet, enabling seamless communication across Earth, satellites, and deep space missions. With energy-efficient solar power and closed-loop life support systems, the vision also foresees resource extraction from asteroids and comets, sustainable human settlements on the Moon and Mars.

NATO releases Commercial Space Strategy

NATO has released its Commercial Space Strategy, outlining NATO's aim to enhance its relationship with commercial space partners and better leverage commercial space services to support defence planning and operations across peace, crisis, and conflict. The Strategy focuses on leveraging commercial solutions for NATO missions, ensuring continuous access through provider agreements and cybersecurity standards, and enhancing coherence with a NATO-wide space interface and a new Space Capabilities Group.

The strategy highlights the growing importance of commercial actors in space, both as providers of essential services and as strategic partners. It also reflects NATO's commitment to safeguarding access to space, promoting innovation, and ensuring security amid an increasingly congested and contested domain. An implementation plan will be developed in close consultation with industry.

European Commission launches Vision for European Space Economy

On 25 June 2025, the European Commission released its "Vision for the European Space Economy", aiming to establish the EU as a global space leader by 2050. The vision sets out over 40 actions to boost Europe's competitiveness, autonomy, and innovation, framing space as a full ecosystem from industry to emerging areas like in-space resources. Key measures include a "Space Team Europe" (a high-level forum of European space actors aimed at increasing coordination and reducing fragmentation), new CASSINI investment tools, and metrics to track global market share. It focuses on six building blocks: a single space market, industrial readiness, skills, international cooperation, commercialisation, and accelerated R&I.

The strategy also links EU space programmes to broader goals like security, mobility, renewables, and Arctic policy, while promoting international cooperation and protecting strategic technologies. Implementation starts immediately across ESA, EUSPA, Member States, and industry.

Joint ESA-EU press conference takes place at Paris Air Show 2025



Credit: ESA

At the Paris Air Show on 18 June 2025, ESA and the European Commission held a joint press conference to reaffirm their close cooperation in space policy, innovation, and sovereignty. ESA Director General Josef Aschbacher and EU Commissioner for Defence and Space Andrius Kubilius stressed the growing strategic importance of space for Europe's autonomy, defence, economy, and technological leadership. They highlighted strong alignment between ESA and the EU on programmes like Copernicus, Galileo, IRIS2, and the Resilience from Space initiative linked to the EU's planned EO Governmental Service. and a shared vision to strengthen Europe's independent launch and in-orbit capabilities, including ambitions for future human access to space, and coordinated preparations for the next Multiannual Financial Framework and ESA's Ministerial Council to align funding and priorities. Both stressed space as a key driver of economic growth, security, and innovation, and reaffirmed their commitment to strengthening Europe's global competitiveness in the space sector.

European Commission releases State of the Digital Decade 2025 report

The European Commission has published the 2025 State of the Digital Decade package, providing a comprehensive update on the status of the EU's digital transformation and assessing progress towards 2030 targets under the Digital Decade Policy Programme. While underlining notable advances in areas like public service digitalisation, 5G coverage, and AI adoption, the report highlights persistent gaps in connectivity, digital skills, energy capacity, and technological independence. It identifies several key challenges, including lagging rollout of connectivity infrastructure, a shortage of skilled ICT professionals, growing AI-related energy demands, and rising concerns over information integrity and online safety. The report also notes delays in advancing dual-use digital technologies due to limited effective collaboration between civil and defence sectors, and vulnerabilities in underdeveloped infrastructure like submarine cables.

German State leaders advocate for increased space funding

The leaders of Bavaria, Baden-Württemberg, and Bremen have jointly called for a substantial increase in Germany's investment in space. At a press conference in Berlin, Prime Minister of Bavaria Markus Söder (CSU), Prime Minister of Baden-Württemberg Winfried Kretschmann (Greens), and Bremen Mayor Andreas Bovenschulte (SPD) proposed **increasing Germany's annual contribution to ESA to €2 billion and allocating €1 billion per year to the national space programme through 2028.**

They highlighted **space as a strategic domain central to scientific progress, economic competitiveness, and European sovereignty.** The proposal comes ahead of the ESA Ministerial Council meeting in Bremen later this year and is supported by industry representatives, who have emphasised the importance of maintaining Germany's role in innovative technologies, such as Earth Observation, secure communications, and independent launch capabilities.

European Commission adopts Defence Readiness Omnibus

The European Commission has adopted the Defence Readiness Omnibus package, a comprehensive set of legislative and non-legislative proposals aimed at enhancing defence preparedness across the EU. Designed to unlock up to €800 billion in investments over four years, the plan includes regulatory and legislative reforms to accelerate capability development across all defence domains, including space. Key measures involve simplified rules for the European Defence Fund to speed up funding, streamlined defence procurement with joint purchasing incentives and faster intra-EU transfers, and fast-tracked permitting for defence infrastructure, including facilities critical to space. It also clarifies environmental and financial regulations to support investments in critical defence technologies, including space-based assets, and strengthens support for cross-border cooperation and SME participation. The Omnibus builds on the 2030 Defence Readiness White Paper and the legislative proposals will now proceed to the European Parliament and the Council for review under the ordinary legislative procedure.

UK Defence and Industrial Strategies Prioritise Space and Tech Innovation

The UK's latest Strategic Defence Review and Industrial Strategy both underscore the country's focus on strengthening strategic sectors. The Defence Review identifies space as a "critical national infrastructure sector" and calls for stronger civil-military alignment, investment in resilient space systems, enhanced deterrence, and a renewed Cabinet sub-Committee to guide space strategy. Meanwhile, **the Industrial Strategy prioritises frontier technologies and industries critical to national security and growth**, including sub-sectors with dual civil-military applications such as space and satellite communications. The strategy also sets out the ambition for innovative UK companies to leverage opportunities in areas such as 5G, future 6G, and advanced optical and satellite communications.

Italy approves its first Space Economy Law

Italy's Senate has given final approval to the Space Economy Law, which constitutes the country's first national regulatory framework dedicated to space activities. The law establishes a regulatory framework for space activities carried out by private operators, aiming to promote the sustainable development of Italy's space industry. It expands the responsibilities of the Italian Space Agency (ASI), which will play a key role as a technical supervisory authority authorising, supervising and sanctioning activities. It also establishes a space economy fund to promote SMEs and innovation. The law has sparked debate, particularly in relation to Article 25, which outlines the intention to establish a national satellite network for reserved transmission capacity.

France increases stake in Eutelsat to support satellite infrastructure growth

The French government will become Eutelsat's largest shareholder following a €1.35 billion capital increase aimed at supporting the company's satellite infrastructure expansion. France will contribute around €1 billion, raising its stake to nearly 30%, as part of efforts to enhance Europe's independent access to space-based services. Eutelsat currently operates over 600 LEO satellites and plans to expand its constellation significantly, requiring up to €2.2 billion in funding. Other shareholders, including Bharti Space, CMA CGM, and Fonds Stratégique de Participations, will also participate.

ESA signs agreement for potential use of Orbital Reef

The European Space Agency has signed a memorandum of understanding with Thales Alenia Space and Blue Origin to explore participation in the proposed Orbital Reef commercial space system. The agreement will study the potential for flying European payloads, potentially including crewed missions, to the space station as well as possible hardware contributions and the use of European vehicles for cargo and crew transport. The agreement forms part of ESA efforts to maintain a continuous presence in LEO following the planned retirement of the ISS, with commercial low Earth orbit destinations (CLDs) as one possible avenue.

Dassault signs agreement with France and ESA on new VORTEX Spaceplane



Credit: Dassault Aviation

French aviation manufacturer Dassault Aviation has signed agreements with the French Ministry of the Armed Forces and the European Space Agency to develop the VORTEX spaceplane. A reusable orbital transport and exploration vehicle, VORTEX would primarily be used to transport cargo and carry out in-orbit services, though Dassault has also identified potential defence applications. The French Ministry of the Armed Forces will support the project's initial stage, the VORTEX-D tech demonstrator, while no specific details are yet available regarding the nature of cooperation between Dassault and ESA.

The Karman Project signs MoU with Jaguar Space

The Karman Project and Jaguar Space have signed a Memorandum of Understanding for a joint mission to send a cultural payload to the International Space Station (ISS), combining scientific research with cultural heritage. The initiative brings together Armenia, Egypt, Nigeria, and Pakistan in a unique collaboration focused on the spaceflight study of culturally significant seeds. The mission will carry four emblematic crops: Egyptian cotton, Armenian pomegranate, Nigerian egusi melon, and Pakistani wheat to the ISS for several days of exposure to microgravity. Upon their return to Earth, the seeds undergo further analysis to enhance understanding of their response to space conditions, with findings contributing to research on spaceflight resilience, climate adaptation, and food security.

Côte d'Ivoire establishes national space agency



Credit: Presidency of the Republic of Côte d'Ivoire

The Côte d'Ivoire Council of Ministers have approved a decree establishing the Space Agency of Côte d'Ivoire (ACSI), mandated to enhance national capabilities and build the institutional and technical foundations for the development of the space sector in Côte d'Ivoire. The agency will also serve as the nation's central institution for coordinating space science and technology initiatives. Its mission includes promoting the use of space-based solutions for sustainable development, expanding domestic expertise, and advancing scientific research. Focus areas will range from Earth Observation and natural resource management to satellite navigation, telecommunications, and space science.

U.S. Space Force awards BAE Systems $1.2 billion contract

The U.S. Space Force has awarded BAE Systems a $1.2 billion contract for the development of 10 missile-tracking satellites for an MEO constellation. Part of the Resilient Missile Warning Tracking Epoch 2 program, this second phase supports the Golden Dome multi-orbit strategy and aims to strengthen U.S. missile defence against emerging threats, including hypersonic weapons. Equipped with advanced heat-sensing technology, the satellite will be designed to provide early warning and tracking, with first delivery expected in fiscal year 2029.

Portugal signs contract for first national SAR satellite

Portugal has signed a contract for the acquisition of its first synthetic aperture radar (SAR) satellite, to be operated by the Portuguese Air Force (FAP). The agreement was formalised by CTI Aeroespacial, a joint initiative of the Air Force, CEIIA, and GEOSAT, in partnership with ICEYE, and funded through Portugal's Recovery and Resilience Plan (PRR). The satellite marks the first in the Atlantic Constellation, a joint Portugal-Spain project that will eventually include 26 Earth Observation satellites (12 SAR, 14 optical). Alongside the contract, a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) was signed to support Portugal's future satellite production capacity.



Credit: Portuguese Air Force

French government launches military space initiatives

France has launched various military space efforts, encompassing space situational awareness initiatives, nanosatellites, and secure communications. The Defence Ministry highlighted the strategic value of nanosatellites for their rapid deployment and capability potential, with plans to boost domestic industry development. Key programmes include Nexus, a partnership with Eutelsat, to enhance France's Syracuse GEO satellites with a new LEO constellation, granting France priority access to the OneWeb network. Additional efforts include Copernic, which accelerates work on energy-efficient digital beamforming antennas by startup Greenerwave and Rivesalt, aimed at improving space situational awareness across all orbital regimes.

ESA partners with Leonardo to address satellite navigation interference

ESA and Leonardo have signed a contract for the joint development of smart antenna technology using Machine Learning to counter satellite navigation interference issues, such as jamming and spoofing. The project, supported under ESA's Navigation Innovation Support Programme (NAVISP), aims to enhance the resilience of GNSS systems by creating smaller, smarter antennas capable of filtering out unwanted signals. The initiative will explore advanced beamforming techniques and test a real-time receiver demonstrator, aiming to reach lab-validated readiness within two years.

Sweden and U.S. sign Technology Safeguards Agreement



Credit: Leigh Green

Sweden and the U.S. have signed the Agreement on Technology Safeguards Associated with U.S. Participation in Space Launches from Sweden. The Agreement establishes the legal and technical framework for U.S. commercial space launches from Swedish spaceports, ensuring the secure management of sensitive technologies. It aims to strengthen U.S.-Sweden cooperation and create new commercial opportunities for both nations' space industries.

President Trump nominates Gen. Guetlein to lead U.S. "Golden Dome program"

U.S. President Donal Trump has officially nominated Space Force Gen. Michael Guelein to serve as the "direct reporting program manager" for the nation's Golden Dome missile defense programme, a national security initiative modelled after Israel's Iron Dome. If confirmed, Guetlein would move from his current role as Vice Chief of Space operations to lead the $175 billion programme.

Axiom Space launches fourth private astronaut mission to ISS

Axiom Space has successfully launched its fourth private astronaut mission to the ISS. The Crew Dragon spacecraft carried a multinational crew of astronauts into orbit on June 25, including Indian test pilot Shubhanshu Shukla, US commander Peggy Whiston, and mission specialists Sławosz Uznański-Wiśniewski of Poland and Tibor Kapu of Hungary. **The launch followed a June 12 announcement by NASA and Axiom Space that the Ax-4 mission would be indefinitely delayed due to a new pressure signature in the ISS's Zvezda module,** where an air leak was first detected in 2019.

African Union launches Space for Early Warning in Africa initiative



Credit: SADC Secretariat

The African Union Commission has officially launched the Space for Early Warning in Africa (SEWA) initiative, designed to enhance the continent's ability to detect, prepare for, and respond to climate-related disasters. The launch event took place in Windhoek, Namibia on 24 June 2025 and symbolises a regional commitment to the integration of space-based technologies into disaster management programmes. It brought together representatives from the African Union, EU, and Namibian government. SEWA forms part of the new Africa-EU Space Partnership and was jointly initiated in 2018 by the African Union Commission, ECMWF, and EUMETSAT under the Abidjan Declaration.

CNES signs partnership with Senegalese Agency for Space Studies



Credit: ASES

France's Centre National d'Études Spatiales (CNES) has signed a strategic partnership with the Agence Sénégalaise d'Études Spatiales (ASES) to advance Senegal's national space sector. The partnership, endorsed at the highest political level, aims to enhance local expertise, promote innovation, and leverage space technologies for sustainable development. Key focus areas include capacity building, technical infrastructure, and joint EO projects. ASES Director General Maram Kaire described the partnership as a reflection of Senegal's vision of "establishing a dynamic and resilient" national space ecosystem that actively contributes towards the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals.

COPUOS addresses key space governance challenges at 68th session



Credit: UNOOSA

From 25 June to 2 July 2025, **the 68th session of the UN Committee on the Peaceful Uses of Outer Space (COPUOS) convened in Vienna**, gathering delegates from 104 Member States, 56 observers, and global space agency leaders. Discussions focused on governance issues, including space traffic coordination, orbital congestion, debris mitigation, lunar activities, and preparations for UNISPACE+50 in 2027. The session also reflected growing African engagement in space diplomacy, with several African states and the African Space Agency actively contributing. Professor Rafiq Akram, Director of Morocco's Royal Centre for Space Studies and Research, was appointed Chair of the Committee.

Blue Origin establishes European office in Luxembourg

Blue Origin has announced the establishment of its new European office to be based in Luxembourg, from which it will manage its European supply chain operation. The announcement followed a meeting between the Minister of Economy, SME, Energy and Tourism, the CEO of Blue Origin, and the Vice President of Global Supply Chain at Blue Origin. The new office aims to strengthen the company's European presence and contribute to the development of commercial space services, including lunar transport, space mobility, and in-space resource use. The cooperation forms part of the SpaceResource.lu initiative, which supports the peaceful and sustainable use of space resources to benefit humanity.

Italy's IRIDE Programme reaches milestone with launch of first satellites

On 23 June 2025, seven satellites were launched for Italy's IRIDE Earth Observation programme, forming part of the Hawk for Earth Observation (HEO) constellation. Developed by Argotec and coordinated by ESA with support from the Italian Space Agency (ASI), the constellation will provide multispectral data to support Italy's environmental, emergency, and security services. Funded by Italy's National Recovery and Resilience Plan (PNRR), IRIDE aims to deploy six satellite constellations in total. The launch, conducted by SpaceX from California, follows the January deployment of the first IRIDE satellite.

Italy launches Cybersecurity Operations Center for space infrastructure



Credit: ASI

The Italian Space Agency (ASI) has commissioned Starion Italia to design and implement a Cyber Security Operations Center (C-SOC) to protect its space and digital infrastructure. Co-financed by Italy's National Recovery and Resilience Plan, the project integrates with ASI's existing systems and involves Deloitte Italia as an industrial partner. In alignment with national and EU strategies for cybersecurity and technological sovereignty, the C-SOC will enhance Italy's operational autonomy and resilience in the space sector.

York Space launches first SDA satellite on SpaceX rideshare

On 23 June 2025, York Space Systems launched Dragoon, the first of 12 military satellites built for the U.S. Space Development Agency (SDA), aboard SpaceX's Transporter-14 rideshare mission from Vandenberg Space Force Base. As part of the SDA's Proliferated Warfighter Space Architecture (PWSA), Dragoon is designed to support secure missile tracking and targeting from LEO. The satellite also debuts York's more powerful LX-class bus. The mission, under the $200 million Tranche 1 Demonstration and Experimentation System (T1DES) programme, reflects the Pentagon's shift from large geostationary satellites to resilient satellite constellations to counter emerging threats.

Bahrain Space Agency launches first payload for cloud detection

The Bahrain Space Agency has launched its first payload, which is designed to detect and identify clouds in satellite images through AI integration. The initiative is being conducted aboard a joint Oman-China satellite, in collaboration with China's "Starvision" and Oman's "Lens of Oman". The AI will be used to detect clouds, replace obscured areas using past data, and enhance image quality for applications like urban planning, environmental monitoring, and ship tracking, while building Bahrain's national capabilities in space-based AI innovation.

China launches fourth group of Guowang megaconstellation satellites



Credit: Ourspace

The China Aerospace Science and Technology Corporation (CASC) has launched a fourth group of satellites for the Guowang LEO megaconstellation, led by the China Satellite Network Group. Official sources have not provided further information regarding the number of satellites or their capabilities.

EgSA Hosts EU Diplomatic Delegation to Strengthen Space Cooperation

The Egyptian Space Agency (EgSA) hosted a delegation of EU Member State diplomats at its Cairo headquarters, showcasing the agency's capabilities and the facilities of the country's newly constructed Space City. The meeting was intended to deepen collaboration between the EU and Egypt in space technology and research, with discussions on potential joint initiatives, collaborative research projects and capacity building. Egypt's diplomatic engagement with the EU forms part of a broader effort to position itself as a regional space leader.

In other news

Senegal joins Space4Ocean Alliance. Senegal has officially joined the International Space4Ocean Alliance, representing a commitment to using space technologies for sustainable ocean management.

EU considers inviting Ukraine to join its GovSatCom and Iris² satellite telecommunications networks, aiming to increase Ukraine's resilience against the ongoing Russian invasion.

Gabon and Chad enhance scientific collaboration with new framework agreement. The agreement aims to advance joint initiatives in applied research, Earth Observation, and technological development.

Democratic Republic of Congo approves Starlink market access. The Democratic Republic of Congo has approved Starlink's entry under its national ICT regulatory framework, enabling the company to operate as an internet service provider. Now active in 22 African countries, Starlink aims to improve connectivity in remote areas.

SpaceX's satellite internet service Starlink launches in Guinea-Bissau, Marking its 22nd African entry, the company gained approval from the national regulator in April 2025.

Senegal's Military and Space Agency sign MoU. Senegal's Armed Forces and the national space agency ASES signed a five-year MoU to integrate space into defence, with support from PROMÉTHÉE Earth Intelligence.

Japanese space sustainability company Astroscale has been awarded a $7 million contract by the U.K. Defence Science and Technology Laboratory (DSTL) through its British subsidiary to deploy two cubesats to monitor space weather and track LEO objects. The contract covers a period of three years, with initial satellite deployment slated for 2027 followed by the one-year-long Orpheus mission.

Pentagon's mega-constellation continues to face supply chain issues. Over two years after the initial identification of supply chain risks in the Space Development Agency's LEO satellite programme, challenges remain that could disrupt deployment schedules.

Russia and Indonesia sign strategic partnership. Indonesia and Russia signed a Strategic Partnership Declaration during President Prabowo's visit to St. Petersburg on 19–20 June 2025.

Russia and Djibouti sign MoU for cooperation in space research. Roscosmos and Djibouti's Ministry of Higher Education signed an MoU on peaceful space cooperation.

Zambia joins Africa Radio Astronomy Network. Zambia joins the African radio astronomy network with its new Transient Array Radio Telescope (TART), enabling space monitoring and training.

NASDRA and GalaxySpace sign MoU. Nigeria's NASDRA partners with GalaxySpace to advance satellite-based D2D connectivity services.

INDUSTRY & BUSINESS

European Commission clears SES-Intelsat deal without conditions

The European Commission has given unconditional approval to SES's plan to buy satellite operator Intelsat, declaring in a statement on June 6 that the merged group would face sufficient competition from terrestrial and LEO alternatives. In May, the UK Competition and Markets Authority had similarly approved the merger, particularly citing competitive pressures in the inflight connectivity market. The deal remains subject to regulatory approval by the U.S. Federal Communications Commission and Department of Justice, with SES expecting to finalise the transaction early in the second half of 2025.

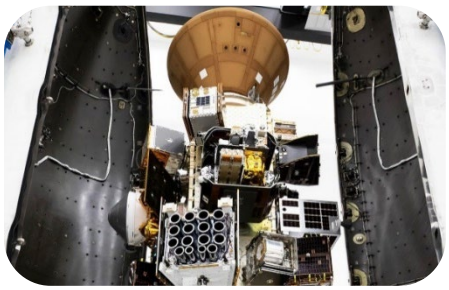
Ukrainian-led private consortium seeks to develop imagery constellation



Credit: BlackSky

A consortium of Ukrainian, Nordic and Eastern European companies plans to raise private funding of over €100 million by the end of 2026 to build a constellation of more than 70 small imagery satellites. The project, led by the industry group Ukrainian Aerospace Clusters' Alliance, seeks to develop a dual-use SSO satellite constellation known as Inmarsat to be operational by the end of the decade. The constellation of optical and SAR satellites would provide daily revisits along the Russian border in order to reduce dependence on US intelligence. According to Alliance CEO Eugen Rokytsky, the project should leverage the joint technological capacities of private companies in Ukraine, the Nordics and Eastern Europe to develop a shared architecture, with the consortium then selling services to European governments.

The Exploration Company plans crewed vehicle and conducts Nyx test flight


Credit: SpaceX

Munich-based start-up The Exploration Company (TEC) unveiled plans for a modified version of its Nyx spacecraft for crewed flights. The company is currently developing a cargo vehicle through an ESA program, with plans for a demonstration flight to the ISS in 2028. According to TEC, a crewed spacecraft could take about 10 years at a cost of €1 billion, supporting future flights to the ISS and commercial space stations. The company has called for a joint European commitment and government support, particularly looking towards the upcoming November 2025 ESA ministerial conference. **TEC recently conducted a test flight of the cargo version of the Nyx spacecraft, dubbed "Mission Possible", on June 23.** Launched on a SpaceX rideshare mission, the re-entry capsule suffered a blackout before splash-down, leading to the loss of the capsule and its payloads.

Arkadia Space tests hydrogen peroxide thruster in orbit

The Spanish space startup Arkadia Space has successfully tested its DARK propulsion system in orbit, a thruster which uses hydrogen peroxide as propellant. The DARK propulsion system was launched as a hosted payload on D-Orbit's ION Satellite Carrier in March. Arkadia CEO Garcia praised the thruster's performance, noting that the company would continue testing for the coming year to measure the system's long-term performance. Arkadia seeks to demonstrate the benefits of green propulsion systems, including easier handling and cost effectiveness in pre-launch fuelling.

Eutelsat Group launches LEO Earth Station in Angola

Eutelsat Group has inaugurated its OneWeb Earth Station in Angola's Luanda-Bengo Special Economic Zone, developed through a partnership between OneWeb Angola and Eutelsat. The station will provide a communications gateway for the Eutelsat OneWeb LEO constellation, bringing the network online in Angola and across Central Africa. Building upon Eutelsat Group's existing presence in Angola's GEO market and ground stations hosted in other African nations, the new Earth station forms part of the company's effort to expand the deployment of its LEO networks to currently underserved communities. For Angola, the investment constitutes a potential step towards positioning the country as a regional hub and exporter of satellite services.

Intelsat partners with WPDI initiative to expand educational access

Intelsat has announced a partnership with the non-profit organisation Whitaker Peace & Development Initiative (WPDI), aiming to expand educational access in conflict-affected regions of East Africa by providing high-speed internet connectivity to WPDI's Community Learning Centres in South Sudan and Uganda. Under a three-year agreement, Intelsat will provide satellite internet to 10 WDPI Community Learning Centres, creating digital access to education for youth in underserved areas. The initiative includes the provision of equipment, installation, and ongoing support, helping to overcome infrastructure gaps and enabling online learning.



Credit: Intelsat

Saab and Maxar Intelligence enter partnership

Swedish aerospace and defence company Saab and geospatial intelligence provider Maxar Intelligence have entered a strategic partnership to jointly develop next-generation battlespace solutions, focusing on targeting capabilities, advanced space-based C5ISR and GPS resilience for autonomous drone systems. Through a Teaming Agreement, Saab will receive access to Maxar's intelligence and mission products, which the company seeks to integrate into its defence systems. The cooperation is intended to accelerate the development of sovereign space-based capabilities in Europe.

iSpace attributes Resilience lunar mission crash to hardware failure



Credit: iSpace

Japan's iSpace has attributed the crash of its second lunar lander mission to a hardware problem with the laser rangefinder used to determine altitude during descent. The company's Resilience spacecraft was lost during its planned Moon landing on June 5, paralleling the previous crash of iSpace's first lunar mission in April 2023. iSpace has not been able to identify the concrete factors behind the rangefinder's failure, though it has announced remedial measures for its upcoming third and fourth mission scheduled for 2027.

BAE Systems and Hanwha Systems sign MoU on multi-sensor satellite platform

British defence company BAE Systems and with South Korea's Hanwha Systems have signed a Memorandum of Understanding to develop a multi-sensor satellite system. The collaboration will explore the integration of Hanwha System's next-generation SAR and BAE's ultra-wideband radio frequency technology, leveraging on-board machine learning. The satellite platform is expected to form part of BAE's planned Azalea ISR constellation. The final system will target international markets, while also helping South Korea meet domestic requirements.

BlackSky unveils wide-area imaging satellite



Credit: BlackSky

US satellite imagery and analytics provider BlackSky has announced plans to develop a new wide-area imaging satellite Aros, scheduled to launch in 2027. The new Earth observation system will focus on capturing large areas, complementing the company's existing Gen-3 satellites which image specific locations with high revisit rates. BlackSky intends to expand its offering in the wide-coverage market and offer a more comprehensive solution, pairing wide-area satellites with its rapid-revisit constellation as part of a "tipping and cueing" approach. No details have yet been disclosed as to the number of satellites or intended production schedule.

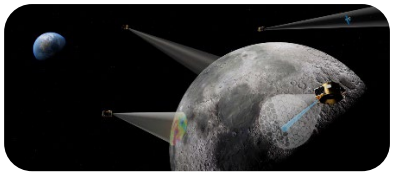
Arianespace seeks to move to increased launch cadence over the next years

Speaking at the Paris Air Show, Arianespace CEO David Cavaillolès reiterated the company's ambition to move to Ariane 6's peak launch cadence as soon as possible but noted that this might take several years to achieve. Ariane 6 has conducted two launches to date since its inaugural flight in July 2024, with plans to increase this rate to 10 launches per year. In 2025, the vehicle is scheduled for four further launches, including the first flight to the more powerful Ariane 64 variant. Arianespace currently faces significant backlog, with a contracted 18 launches for Amazon's Project Kuiper broadband satellites. By 2029 and 2030, the company expects to perform 13 Ariane 64 launches for the deployment of the IRIS² constellation.

SSC and Firefly advance orbital launch plans following U.S.-Sweden TSA

The Swedish Space Corporation (SSC) and US company Firefly Aerospace are progressing toward the first orbital satellite launch from Esrange Space Centre in Sweden, following the signing of a U.S.-Sweden Technology Safeguards Agreement (TSA) on 20 June 2025. With regulatory barriers cleared, SSC and Firefly are continuing infrastructure development at Esrange's Launch Complex 3C for Firefly's Alpha rocket. The partnership aims to meet growing European demand for launch services and enhance NATO-aligned responsive space capabilities.

Firefly Aerospace announces commercial lunar imagery service



Credit: Firefly Aerospace

Firefly Aerospace has announced plans to offer a commercial lunar imaging service called Ocula, constituting the first such commercial service and a possible high-resolution replacement for NASA's Lunar Reconnaissance Orbiter. According to Firefly, imagery will be provided by telescopes placed on its Elytra spacecraft. The company plans to start offering the service to commercial and government customers after the launch of its Blue Ghost 2 lunar lander mission and a first Elytra spacecraft in 2026, though it did not specify a price. Potential use cases of the imagery system include space domain awareness, but also the identification of key minerals.

Sierra Space creates defence-focused business unit

Colorado-based aerospace firm Sierra Space has formally launched Sierra Space Defense, a new business unit focused on national security programs. The division, led by Sierra Space Vice President and former Lockhead Martin executive Erik Daehler, formalises Sierra Space's increasing shift towards defence contracts. **As part of the reorganisation, the company plans to build a new manufacturing facility "Victory Works" in Colorado**, which will be dedicated to defence technology, including production of the company's new Eclipse satellite bus line.

Rocket Lab launches third iQPS satellite in three months

Rocket Lab's Electron has launched the third radar imaging satellite in three months for Japanese SAR satellite company iQPS, under a multi-launch contract comprising eight launches until 2026. iQPS currently operates eight SAR imaging satellites, with plans to grow this constellation to 36 spacecraft in the coming years.

POLARIS partners with Diehl to equip spaceplanes with air-to-air missiles



Credit: POLARIS/Diehl Defence

POLARIS Spaceplanes has partnered with German defence contractor Diehl Defence to arm its uncrewed vehicles with IRIS-T air-to-air missiles, unveiling the Airborne Launching and Attack System (AirLAS) at the 2025 Paris Air Show. The system appears mounted on POLARIS' MIRA II or III demonstrators, originally designed as testbeds for the future AURORA spaceplane. Though POLARIS has focused on space and hypersonic transport, recent funding and developments, such as in-flight refuelling from the German miliary, indicate a growing shift towards defence applications.

Rheinmetall and Anduril partner on autonomous defence systems for Europe

Rheinmetall and U.S.-based Anduril Industries have announced a strategic partnership for the co-development and production of autonomous defence systems tailored to European needs. The collaboration will integrate European variants of Anduril's low-cost autonomous air vehicle, (Barracuda), high-performance unmanned aircraft (Fury), and solid rocket motors into Rheinmetall's digital sovereignty platform "Battlesuite". The systems will be built in Europe using sovereign suppliers, aiming for rapid production, modularity, and alignment with NATO standards.

Cangyu Space Technology plans mixed-orbit data relay satellite system

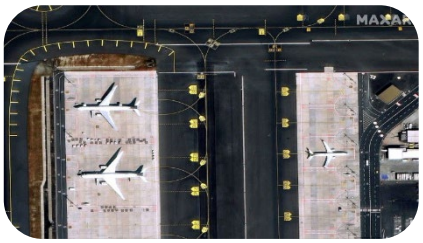
The Chinese company Cangyu Space Technology has announced plans for a commercial data relay constellation, consisting of 13 satellites in different orbits. The hybrid system combining MEO, GEO and IGSO systems is intended to enable space-based information transmission with global coverage. Use cases identified by Cangyu include data relay for UAVs, maritime and aviation systems, launch vehicle telemetry and the Internet of Things, including as part of the infrastructural projects of China's Belt and Road Initiative. The company plans to deploy the first GEO Cangyu-1 satellite by the end of 2026.

Ursa Major and Stratolaunch enter $32.9 million contract for hypersonic testing

US-based rocket engine manufacturer Ursa Major has entered a contract worth $32 million with California-based aerospace firm Stratolaunch to supply 16 advanced propulsion systems for Stratolaunch's Talon-A reusable hypersonic vehicle. Ursa Major will deliver an upgraded variant of its Hadley engine, termed H13, which increases engine reusability and cost effectiveness. Stratolaunch is supplying the Talon-A as a test platform under U.S. Department of Defense contract, which has integrated various private firms to accelerate hypersonic flight testing.

Maxar launches intelligence service focused on 'persistent monitoring'

US-based company Maxar Intelligence has launched a new monitoring service called Sentry, which will provide customers with continuous surveillance capabilities across multiple global locations. The move is part of Maxar's efforts to expand from satellite imagery into the higher-value intelligence market. The Sentry platform will draw upon the company's software platform of current and historical satellite imagery, aggregating data from Maxar's own satellite systems and partner constellations. Potential use cases include energy security, trade monitoring or law enforcement.



Credit: Maxar Intelligence

Executives warn against budget cuts to commercial remote sensing programs

In a letter addressed to lawmakers of the U.S. Congress on June 16, the CEOs of leading U.S. satellite imaging firms have warned that proposed budget cuts to the National Reconnaissance Office's commercial imagery programs could undermine national security and reverse progress in the integration of private sector capabilities with defence and intelligence operations. The firms, including Maxar Technologies, Planet, Black Sky, Iceye US, Capella Space and KSAT, urged lawmakers to reject the cuts, arguing that they stood in contrast with executive branch guidance, congressional mandates and the strategic requirements of competition with China.

Honda successfully tests experimental reusable rocket

On 17 June 2025, Honda R&D successfully conducted its first launch and landing test of an independently developed experimental reusable rocket in Hokkaido, Japan. The 6.3-metre rocket reached an altitude of 271.4 metres and landed within 37cm of the target after a 56.6-second flight. The test demonstrated key reusability technologies, including flight stability and precision landing.



Credit: Honda

In other news

Spanish IT and defence company Indra announces the creation of Indra Space, a new business unit spanning the entire space project value chain. The move forms part of Indra Group's ambition to strengthen its position in the European space industry, reinforcing its capabilities across the area of Earth observation, secure communications, geopositioning and space surveillance. **In February 2025 Indra had announced an agreement to acquire satellite firms Hispasat and Hisdesat**, subject to regulatory and shareholder approval.

Speaking at the Paris Air Show, Airbus executives note a stabilisation in the company's space business. Having taken on €1,3 billion and €600 million in charges in 2024 and 2023, respectively, linked to poor cost and schedule performance on the company's satellite programs, Airbus Space and Defense has implemented a turnaround plan including significant job reductions. Progress to this end comes as the company is negotiating about a potential combination with Leonardo and Thales Alenia Space.

INVESTMENT & FINANCE

Space Venture 2024 is out!



ESPI has released the 2024 edition of Space Venture, which provides an overview and analysis of the evolution of global investments in space sector. The report seeks to inform policymakers in optimising public funding to attract private investment and unlock broader societal benefits.

This 2024 edition provides several key findings:

- Global investment has reached **€6.9 billion** in 2024, a 6% year-on-year (YoY) increase.
- For the first time, **the U.S. accounts for less than half of the total global investment**, raising only €2.9 billion, against €1.5 billion for Europe and €1.9 billion for China.
- **VC remains the primary vehicle of private funding**, representing 72% of tracked global investment.

Since 2014, in **Europe**, ESPI has recorded 631 transactions amounting to €9.8 billion. The €1.5 billion raised in 2024 alone represents a **56% YoY** increase, the largest recorded since 2014. This growth is partly driven by **growing investments into security and defence** use cases, with companies explicitly targeting these lines securing a relative investment weight of 40%. The top five European ventures have attracted **€681 million** in 2024, with the largest transaction of the year being Safran's acquisition of Preligens for €220 million in another defence-driven investment. **Late-stage rounds** are on an upward trend, with €473 million secured in Series C+ rounds and the first-ever Series E.

Public support was instrumental in the strong performances of European venture, with nearly 80% of capital raised coming from public or mixed consortia. When compared with the U.S., two distinct scaling strategies appear. Europe's public actors usually **operate as direct or co-investors**, crowding in private players. In the U.S., the large space budget – €73.6 billion, almost 5 times larger than Europe's - guarantees **substantive and recurring procurement contracts**, bringing in revenues and rendering companies attractive to private investors. This is further illustrated by the ratio between private investments and space budgets, which has **decreased in the U.S.**, due to a drop in private investment and rise in public budget, and **increased in Europe**, with a marginal increase in budget but a surge in private investment declines.

ESPI also partners with **partners** to enrich Space Venture with regional insights.

- **Orbital Gateway Consulting** reported **Satcom as driving China's 2024 performance**, with constellation operators raising €1 billion and a drop in funding for other verticals.
- **SpaceinAfrica** reported **four companies raising over $30 million** across six funding rounds, with 86% of African space ventures still relying on self-funding.
- **SPACETIDE** reported the Japan's ecosystem as maturing, with **80% of the investment going to Series B+ rounds between 2020 and 2024**, compared to 41% between 2015 and 2019.

The full report can be found **here**, and the key takeaways can be accessed **here**.

Impulse Space raises $300 million for in-space mobility



Credit: Impulse Space

Impulse Space has raised **$300 million in a Series C round** led by Linse Capital. 2027. Impulse Space seeks to answer the commercial and institutional demand for increased speed and agility in the repositioning of satellites. The U.S. start-up dedicated to in-orbit operations is currently building Helios, a kick stage designed to lift 5 tons from LEO to GEO, expected to debut in 2026. In line with this product, the company is preparing to provide dedicated smallsat GEO Rideshare missions starting in 2027. The funding will be directed towards vertical integration, scaling production of Mira (their existing manoeuvrable space vehicle for in-orbit servicing), continue the development of Helios and expand the workforce.

Isar secures €150 million for expansion of production capacities

Isar Aerospace has announced an **agreement with U.S. holding Elridge Industries for a convertible bond of €150 million**. Isar develops its Spectrum launcher, with a first test flight having occurred last March from Andøya Spaceport, in Norway, which ended up in a loss of altitude and fall back shortly after liftoff. The convertible bond, whose specifics are not mentioned, will add up to the over €400 million that the German startup has raised so far. Isar plans on directing the investment towards the expansion of its launch and series production capacities.

ICEYE considers IPO in the next three years, secures €41.1 million

ICEYE's CEO Rafal Modrzewski commented that ICEYE is likely to IPO in the next three years, as it expects to breach $200 million in revenues this year following defence and security-motivated demand from governments. In the meantime, the company has launched a €250 million investment programme to The plan will leverage ICEYE's increasing revenues as well as **€41.1 million from Business Finland**, the country's innovation agency, with the blended funding including €35.4 million in loans and €5.7 million in grants. ICEYE manufactures and operates its constellation of SAR satellites, delivering EO insights to both institutional and commercial customers in the defence, security, insurance, or crisis response industries.

Multiverse Computing raises €122 million for AI models compression

The Spanish start-up has secured **€122 million in a Series B** round led by Bullhound Capital, following an equity investment by the Spanish government of €67 million through the Spanish Society for Technological Transformation (SETT) last March. Multiverse Computing works on quantum-inspired software to compress AI models up to 10% of their original size. The start-up has ESA and Hispasat as partners, seeking to automate satellite docking and enable intensive simulations. Multiverse Computing will leverage the investment to accelerate the adoption of its solutions in order to tackle the costs of Large Language Models roll-out.

MULTIVERSE COMPUTING

Credit: Multiverse Computing

Muon Space raises $89.5 million, acquires Starlight Engines



Credit: Muon Space

Muon Space has secured **$89.5 million in a second Series B tranche** led by Congruent Ventures, with the funding consisting of $44.5 million in equity and $45 million in credit facilities. The U.S. start-up develops end-to-end EO services, manufacturing the hardware, designing the software, and providing operations tools for customers leveraging the product. Muon Space has also acquired Starlight Engines, a start-up building hall-effect thruster systems, which will be powering Muon's Halo spacecraft. Other uses of the capital include further integration of RF instruments, expansion of the company's ground station network, and release of their constellation operations platform.

iRocket and BPGC Acquisition Corp. plan for $400 million SPAC merger

U.S. start-up iRocket and the special-purpose acquisition company (SPAC) BPGC Acquisition Corp. **have announced a $400 million non-binding letter of intent for a proposed business combination**. iRocket is developing an entirely reusable launch vehicle, dubbed Shockwave, powered by liquid rocket engines, and has plans to develop solid engines for missiles and boosters. The company has been awarded two contracts with the DoD, a $1.8 million TACFI and $18 million CRADA. The transaction, which values iRocket at $400 million, would see BPGC Acquisition, a blank check company backed by PE firm BPGC Management, and iRocket become a combined entity to be listed on Nasdaq. A definitive agreement is expected during the summer of this year, for a closing before the end of 2025.

Nominal secures $75 million for rapid design iteration software

The U.S. start-up has raised **$75 million in a Series B** round led by Sequoia Capital. Nominal develops software enabling fast-moving, hardware-intensive companies to rapidly iterate on their design and testing phases, through two platforms: 'Core', for cloud data analysis, and 'Connect', for operations automation and syncing. The company sees an opportunity to modernise the legacy stack that underpins the development of products like satellites or rocket engines. **The capital will be used to** increase the team, market expansion towards other industries, and the opening of an office in Washington for liaising with institutional customers.

Xona Space Systems raises $92 million for PNT constellation



Credit: Xona Space Systems

Xona Space Systems has secured **$72 million in a Series B** round led by Craft Ventures, with an additional $20 million coming from a SpaceWERX award, the innovation arm of the U.S. Space Force. Xona Space Systems plans to deploy a LEO constellation of 258 satellites for positioning, navigation, and timing (PNT). The commercial service, named Pulsar, is of particular interest to the U.S. military, which could leverage its capacities to provide enhanced guiding for uncrewed and autonomous operations. The U.S. start-up has launched its first satellite, Pulsar-0, on June 20 aboard Transporter-14, and will attempt to validate the technology, including resistance to jamming and stronger signal penetration, through live testing with early customers.

Look Up raises €50 million for space surveillance network



Credit: ESPI

The French start-up has secured **€50 million in a Series A** round, combining €24 million in equity led by ETF Partners, €15 million in non-dilutive funding from the European Union, and the remainder in debt financing from several undisclosed financial institutions. Look Up specialises in the SSA and SDA domains, operating a radar network that delivers a European solution in detection and tracking capabilities.

The start-up has deployed and operates the first node of its network in Lozère (France) and will install two additional radars in French Polynesia. Other planned uses of the investment include the launch of an Operations Center, an in-orbit demonstration to validate Look Up's Space-Operations-as-a-Service model, and global expansion.

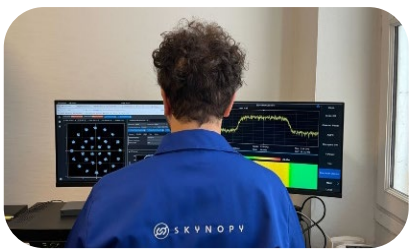
Logos Space Services raises $50 million for secure broadband constellation

Logos Space Services has secured **$50 million in a Series A** round backed by venture capital firm U.S. Innovative Technologies, The U.S. start-up seeks to build a broadband LEO constellation of over 4000 satellites, operating at an orbit of 900 kilometres, focused on performance, reliability, and security, to service the connectivity needs of enterprises and Government agencies. The technology involves high frequencies and tightly aimed radio beams to provide resilience against jamming and interference, The capital will enable progress towards critical design phases and prototype development, for a first deployment in late 2027.

Quantum Space secures $40 million for national security spacecraft

The U,S, start-up has raised **$40 million in a Series A extension**. Quantum Space develops a spacecraft, Ranger, initially designed in the framework of a cislunar constellation dubbed "QuantumNet", and tasked with carrying various payloads for communication, navigation, or SSA purposes. The company has now pivoted towards national security missions, seeking to play a role in the Golden Dome architecture, rebranding Ranger as a responsive, manoeuvrable and configurable platform to navigate contested space environments. The funding will go towards further development of Ranger for a planned initial launch in Q1 2026.

Skynopy secures €15 million for deployable ground stations



Credit: Skynopy

The French start-up has raised **€15 million in a funding round** led by Alven Capital Partners. Skynopy operates a network of 18 proprietary and third-party ground stations, and established partnerships with stakeholders such as AWS and Kineis. The start-up claims to offer double the traditional download capacity per satellite pass for operators of LEO constellations, at a revisit rate of under 20 minutes, by leveraging its combined and connected virtualised modem architecture. Skynopy plans on allocating the funding towards hires, accelerating the deployment of its offer, and preparing for the development of AKAR, a unified and real-time space network planned for 2028.

AccelerComm raises $15 million for space-based 5G networks



Credit: AccelerComm

UK start-up AccelerComm has **raised $15 million in a funding round** led by IP Group. The company develops technology for delivering 5G internet via satellites, seeking to improve mobile coverage in areas where traditional cell towers are not available. AccelerComm is working with Lockheed Martin on a satellite project that aims to process 5G signals directly in space. The new funding will support the company's efforts to advance its products, particularly for connecting smartphones directly to satellites.

Beijing DianQing secures nearly CN¥100 million for electric systems

The Chinese start-up has raised nearly **CN¥100 million (approx. €12 million) in a Series A+ round** led by Shanshan Corporation. Beijing DianQing develops and manufactures high-power electric integrated systems for both planes and spacecraft, and conducts work on the Chinese space programme through partnerships with state-owned China Aerospace Science and Industry Corporation (CASIC) and main contractor China Aerospace Science and Technology Corporation (CASC). The funding will go towards further R&D, production scaling and market expansion.

Jua secures $11 million for AI-powered forecasts

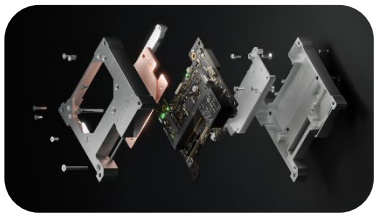
Jua has raised **$11 million in a Series A round** co-led by Ananda Impact Ventures and Future Energy Ventures. The Swiss start-up is behind an AI-powered platform built around a "Large Physics Model", trained on raw environmental data. The technology, allowing simulation and forecasts of meteorological phenomena, is used by stakeholders in the energy sector to anticipate changes and manage risks. The capital will be leveraged to expand towards new markets and deepen the reach of the product within the energy sector, accelerate market penetration, and R&D.

Aistech Space raises €8.5 million for thermal imagery constellation

The Spanish start-up has secured **€8.5 million in a Series B round**, which saw Global Portfolio Investment contribute €8 million and Peliga Family Office €500k. Aistech develops Hydra, a constellation of thermal imagery satellites designed to monitor temperatures changes on Earth, supporting efforts in climate monitoring, water management, and critical infrastructure surveillance. The company has launched three satellites to date and has plans for six more by the end of 2026. The funding will go towards business scaling, international expansion, and hires.

Aethero raises $7.7 million for in-orbit processing

The U.S. start-up has secured **$7.7 million in a Seed round** led by Kindred Ventures. Aethero builds radiation-hardened computing units around different architectures, as well as the software to run them. Applications for the technology include autonomous space operations, object detection, or data processing. The company, which has flown a first mission in 2024, will direct the capital towards preparing for its second in February 2026, and a third, at an unspecific date.



Credit: Aethero

In other news

POLARIS secures oversubscribed €5.3 million top-up co-led by Capnamic Ventures Bremen and Spacewalk VC: The German start-up developing AURORA, a multipurpose orbital spaceplane plans on allocating the capital in producing the first serial plane, and pre-fund customer contracts.

Letara secures additional funding from Frontier Innovations and closes a ¥800 million (approx. €4.8 million) Seed round: the company builds hybrid propulsion systems for small satellites, using solid plastic as fuel and specifically designed for safe and rapid last-mile transportation capabilities. The start-up will direct the capital towards R&D to prepare for a first orbital demonstration in 2026.

Lux Aeterna emerges from stealth and secures $4 million in a pre-Seed round led by Space Capital: the U.S. start-up builds satellite buses that could be reused up to 15 times without any components being replaced, targeting companies conducting testing or manufacturing in orbit. While Lux Aeterna has not specified how it intended to use the funding, the start-up has plans for a first demonstration in early 2027.

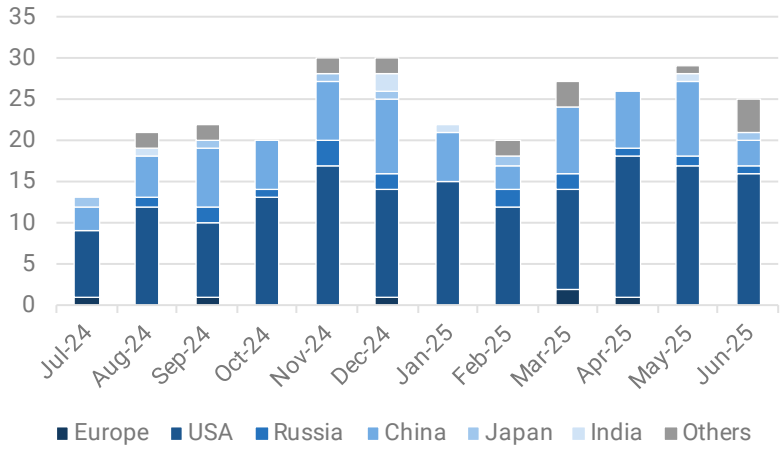
Traveler raises "tens of millions of yuan" (CN¥10 million = €1.2 million) in an angel round: the Chinese start-up seeks to develop a manned spacecraft for both cargo and space tourism by 2028, with an end-objective of manned lunar missions in a 12 to 15-year timeframe. The capital will be used to further advance the development of the vehicle.

LAUNCHES & SATELLITES

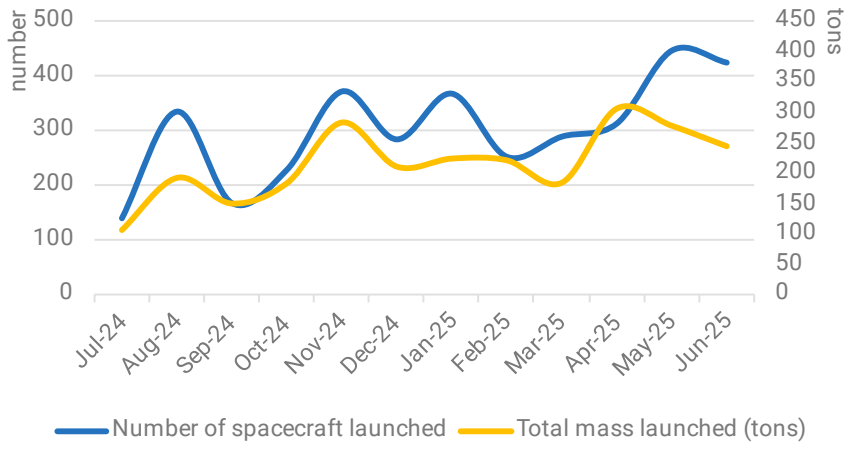
Global space activity statistics

June 2025	USA	China	Russia	Japan	Other	Total
Number of launches	17	3	1	1	4	**25**
Number of spacecraft launched	407	7	1	1	7	**423**
Mass launched (in kg)	224 262	11 230	5000	2600	470	**243 5622**

Launch activity over the year

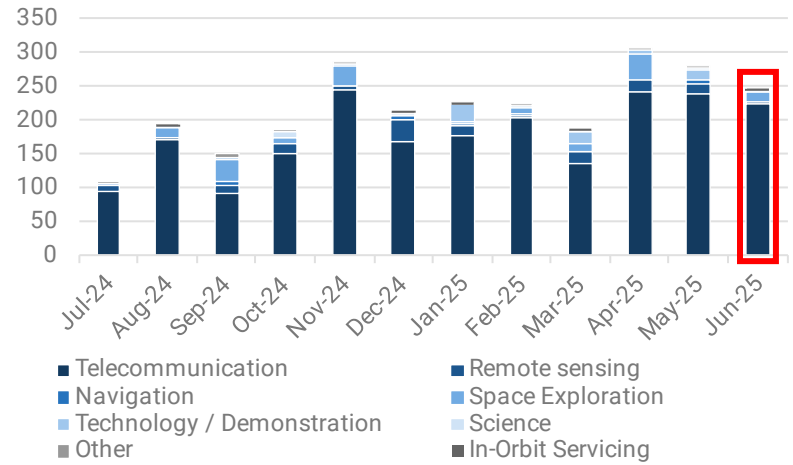


Evolution of the number of launches per launch country



Evolution of launch activity over the year 2024-2025

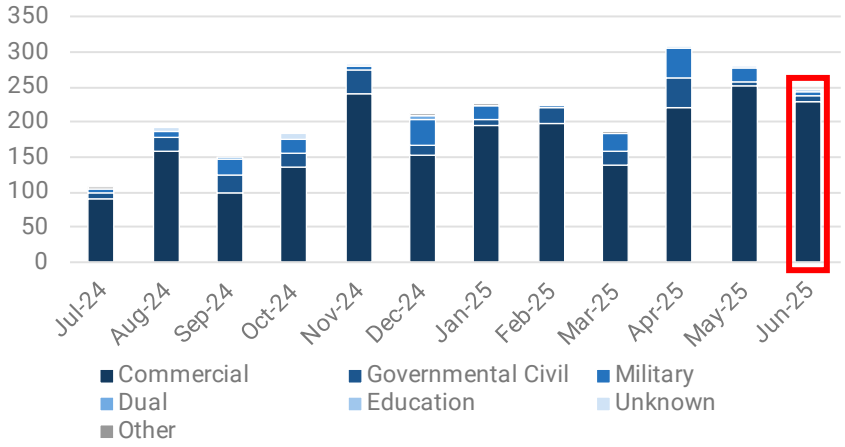
Satellite missions and markets



Evolution of the total mass launched (tons) per mission (Jul. 2024-Jun. 2025)

June 2025	Telecommunication	Remote sensing	IOS	Exploration	Science	Tech/ Dem.	Other
Europe	16	1320	200		2	1740	
USA	207 267	561		12 055	16	717	
China	10 500				730		
Russia	5000						
Japan		2700				150	
Other	180	253				129	26

Total mass (kg) launched by mission and customer country



Evolution of the total mass launched (tons), per market (Jul. 2024-Jun. 2025)

June 2025	Commercial	Governmental Civil	Military	Education
Europe	2562	564	150	2
USA	220 234	24	350	8
China	5500	5730		
Russia			5000	
Japan	250	2600		
Other	562	20		6

Total mass (kg) launched by market and customer country

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